It was only after the 73rd and 74th Amendments effected to the Constitution (1992) that the role of local bodies and their importance in the process of planned development was accepted and the views of Jayprakash got vindicated.

Some Area-wise Reports

The idea for the need of a planned development of India became more and more popular by the decade of the 1940s. It was under this popular pressure that the Government of India started taking some planned actions in this direction. In the 1940s, we see several area-specific reports being published:[28]

(i) Gadgil Report on Rural Credit
(ii) Kheragat Report on Agricultural Development
(iii) Krishnamachari Report on Agricultural Prices
(iv) Saraiya Report on Cooperatives
(v) A series of Reports on Irrigation (ground water, canal, etc.)

All these reports, though prepared with great care and due scholarship, the Government had hardly any zeal to implement plans on their findings. But independent India was greatly benefited when the planning started covering all these areas of concerns.

There is no doubt in drawing the conclusion that prior to independence, there was thus a significant measure of agreement in India between the Government of India under the Secretary of State, the Indian National Congress, prominent industrialists and the others on the following principles:[29]

(i) There should be central planning, in which the state should play an active part, for social and economic development to bring about a rapid rise in the standards of living;
(ii) There should be controls and licencing in order, among other things, to direct investments into the desired channels and ensure equitable distribution;
(iii) While there should be balanced development in all sectors of the economy, the establishment of basic industries was specially